

Andreas D. Sihotang

University of Arkansas | Clinton School of Public Service

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Summary

I am a scholar and practitioner with nearly 20 years of field experience leading various community-based development programs in rural Indonesia. My expertise and research encompasses participatory planning, citizen engagement, social accountability, global and rural development, and program evaluation. I bring a comparative perspective that bridges global and domestic contexts, applying lessons from international development to address persistent challenges including in rural America, such as health disparities, education inequities, and civic engagement. My work focused on strengthening community participation and resilience while ensuring that public service interventions were sensitive to local dynamics, experiences that resonate with ongoing efforts in the U.S. to build trust and cohesion in divided or marginalized communities.

Education

Ph.D. in Public Affairs

2023

University of Missouri, Columbia, MO

Dissertation: *Three Essays on Public Participation and Government Performance*

My dissertation examined various types of public participation—direct and indirect participation, political and non-political participation, or thick and thin participation—on different types of government performance. I applied empirical strategies such as staggered difference-in-differences, synthetic control method, and logistic regressions in these studies.

- Essay I: “Does participatory budgeting improve public service performance? Evidence from New York City” (published in *Public Management Review* in 2023)
- Essay II: “Twenty Years After Democratization: Evaluating Indonesia’s Economic Trajectory Using Synthetic Control Method” (submitted to *Pacific Affairs*)
- Essay III: “Equity in ICT-based Coproduction: Evidence from San Francisco” (Under Reviewed in *Information Polity*)

M.A. in Conflict Transformation 2010
Eastern Mennonite University, Harrisonburg, VA

Capstone Project: Desk research for World Vision International's Fragility Index and Conflict Assessments

B.Eng. in Mining Engineering 1999
Institut Teknologi Bandung, Indonesia

Academic Work Experience

University of Arkansas – Clinton School of Public Service

- Assistant Professor 2024 – present
- Research Fellow at Open Governance Lab 2024 – present
- Research Fellow at Impact Center 2025 – present

University of Missouri – Truman School of Government and Public Affairs

- Post-Doctoral Fellow – Teaching 2023-2024

Publications

Sihotang, Andreas. D. (2023). "Does Participatory Budgeting Improve Public Service Performance? Evidence from New York City". *Public Management Review*.
<https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/full/10.1080/14719037.2023.2212259>

Kraft, J.M., Paina, L., Boydell, V., Elnakib, S., Sihotang, A., Bailey, A., Tolmie, C. (2022). Social Accountability for Research (SAR4Research): checklist to strengthen reporting on studies on social accountability in the literature. *International Journal for Equity in Health*, 21(121) <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12939-022-01716-2>

Sihotang, Andreas. D., Silalahi, Terry. (2006). Becoming Inclusive: Long-Term Benefits of LCP in Programme Strategy. In Garred, Michelle & Abu-Nimer, Mohammed (Eds), *A Shared Future: Local Capacities for Peace in Community Development* (pp. 33 – 45). World Vision International.
<https://www.wvi.org/publication/shared-future>

Manuscripts Under Review

“Equity in ICT-based Coproduction: Evidence from San Francisco”, Under Reviewed at *Information Policy*.

Work in Progress

“Do citizens reward high performers or prioritize failing services? The role of performance information in participatory budgeting” with Meagan Jordan, Songkhun Nillasihanukroh, & Robert Richards.

“Signals and Voice: Performance grades and parental coproduction in NYC public schools” with Weijie Wang and Jiwoong Jung.

“Extending informal civic education to underrepresented communities” (book chapter) with Songkhun Nillasihanukroh, Chul Hyun Park, Matthew Reeds, and Robert Richards.

“Global Citizens, Local Actors: Exploring the perceptions and motivations of international students’ civic participation beyond campus” with Songkhun Nillasihanukroh, Robert Richards, and Oladotun Awosusi.

Teaching

Instructor of Record, University of Arkansas – Clinton School of Public Service

- *CSPS 7333 – Program Planning and Development* Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025
Designed and taught a graduate-level course guiding Master of Public Service students through the full cycle of program planning to address pressing community problems. Course content covers needs assessment, program goals and objectives, best practices research, logic models and theories of change, program monitoring and evaluation, and program sustainability. Students learn to apply these steps to address real-world challenges such as food insecurity, maternal mortality, underage drinking, teen pregnancy, mental illness, and youth violence—issues that are also salient in rural America. Instruction combines lectures with group discussions using case studies drawn from both U.S. and international contexts. Students present their program plans for peer review before submitting a comprehensive final program planning paper.
- *CSPS 7331 – Theory and Practice of Global Development* Spring 2025
Developed and taught a graduate course introducing Master of Public Service students to theoretical frameworks explaining why some countries achieve development while others remain underdeveloped. The course examines international factors (colonialism, neocolonialism, globalization, foreign aid), domestic factors (economic, political, and social institutions), and natural factors shaping development trajectories in the Global South. Through case studies,

students apply the theories to critically analyze the causes of underdevelopment in a particular country and discuss global development practices aligned with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). The final assignment is a country briefing in which students select a developing country—often where they will complete their international public service project—and apply theoretical frameworks to diagnose the causes of underdevelopment in this country while recommending policy and programmatic responses that contribute to some of the SDGs. Students present their analyses for peer feedback before submitting the final paper.

- *CSPS 7332 – Capstone Proposal*
Fall 2025

Guiding Master of Public Service students in developing Capstone proposal that they will implement in the next semester. In this course, students propose the topic for their capstone—often based on the agreement with their partner organizations, state the problem their capstone project will address, develop research questions their capstone will answer, conduct literature review, propose methodology, draft project timeline, send documents for IRB reviews, and submit final capstone proposal.

Instructor of Record, University of Missouri

- *PA 8180 – Research Methods & Inquiry in Public Affairs I*
Spring 2024

Developed and taught a graduate course guiding Master of Public Administration students to understand fundamentals of statistics and apply it in the field of public affairs. The course taught the MPA students how to develop research questions, generate hypothesis, design a research approach, and analyze data using statistical techniques learned in the course such as t-test, bivariate and multivariate regressions. Students practiced these methods using provided datasets and applied what they have learned throughout the course to an independent final research project. Students presented their analyses for peer feedback before submitting the final paper.

- *PA 8210 – Public Service and Democracy* Fall 2023, Spring 2024

Developed and taught a graduate seminar examining ethical dilemmas in public service within liberal democratic contexts. The course explored the motivations, constraints, and obligations of the people who work in public institutions and the people they serve. Students are engaged with key concepts including public values, ethics in governance, public service motivation, power, participation, representation, and inequality. Instruction combined case studies, simulations, and group projects to foster applied learning. In a major assignment, student teams analyzed a recent morally contested policy decision, identified the ethical framework underlying the public leader's justification, proposed an alternative framework, and assessed the ethical trade-offs between different courses of action. The course emphasized critical thinking, ethical reasoning, and practical application of ethical frameworks to real-world policy challenges.

Teaching Assistant, University of Missouri

- *PA 8181 – Research Methods & Inquiry in Public Affairs II* (in-person)
Spring 2023
- *PA 8210 – Public Service and Democracy* (in-person) Fall 2022
- *PA 8181 – Research Methods & Inquiry in Public Affairs II* (online) Fall 2021 &
Spring 2022

Applied Research and Service in Higher Education

Research Fellow, Open Governance Lab, Clinton School of Public Service Fall 2024 – present

Since Fall 2024, I join Clinton School of Public Service's Open Governance Lab and collaborate with other Clinton School of Public Service faculty members, Dr. Robert Richards and Dr. Songkhun Nillasihanukroh, to develop research plan, apply for research grants, conduct research, and present the findings, and publish the paper. In 2024, I co-presented the study by Open Governance Lab that evaluate and compare civic engagement across states in the U.S.

Research Fellow, Impact Center, Clinton School of Public Service Fall 2025 – present

I assist Clinton School of Public Service's Impact Center led by Dr. Nichola Driver to provide rigorous applied research and evaluation services that are accessible to public service organizations. I recently assisted the Impact Center to analyze and write data analysis report for Bowen School of Law, University of Arkansas at Little Rock, for a study on Veteran Treatment Court. The study aimed to understand barriers and challenges of accessing and completing VTC programs.

Research Assistant, University of Missouri

- *Institute of Public Policy* Summer 2019, 2020, 2021

Guest Lecturer/Speaker

- *Latent Conflict* (online), Mahia de Kognita and World Vision Indonesia, October 2025
- *Introduction to Econometrics* (online), Graduate Program of Economic and Business, University of Indonesia, November 2022
- *Poverty* (online), Institute for Economic and Social Research, University of Indonesia, September 2022
- *Realist Evaluation* (in-person), Kartu Prakerja (Pre-Employment Card) Program, Coordinating Ministry for Economic Affairs – Republic of Indonesia, July 2022

Facilitator of Training and Workshops

- *Citizen Voice and Action* – World Vision, Dili – Timor Leste, June 2018
- *Citizen Voice and Action* – World Vision, Bangkok – Thailand, April 2018.
- *Introduction to Realist Evaluation*, World Vision, Jakarta – Indonesia, March 2018.
- *Citizen Voice and Action* – World Vision, Jakarta – Indonesia, February 2018
- *Integrating Peacebuilding and Conflict Sensitivity*, World Vision, Nairobi – Kenya, May 2014.
- *Integrating Peacebuilding and Conflict Sensitivity*, World Vision, Jakarta – Indonesia, February 2014.
- *Making Sense for Turbulent Context in Papua*, World Vision, Jakarta – Indonesia, August 2010.
- *Local Capacities for Peace Training of Trainers*, World Vision, Kandy – Sri Lanka, May 2007
- *Local Capacities for Peace Assessment Facilitator*, World Vision, Pune – India, February 2006
- *Community Based Assessment of Do No Harm / Local Capacities for Peace*, World Vision, Davao – Philippines, January 2005.
- *Integrating Peacebuilding and Development*, World Vision, Phnom Penh – Cambodia, May 2004.
- *Integrating Peacebuilding in Transformational Development*, World Vision, Arusha – Tanzania, August 2003.

Project Evaluation Experience

- Baseline and Evaluation, World Vision Indonesia's '*Citizen Voice and Action for Government Accountability and Improved Services*' Project, 2014 to 2018.
- Baseline and Evaluation, World Vision Indonesia's '*Papua Peace Education*' and '*Central Sulawesi Harmony Education*' Projects, 2010 to 2014.
- Baseline and Evaluation, World Vision Indonesia's '*Banggai – Area Development Program*', 2004 to 2008.
- Conflict Assessments and analysis, World Vision Indonesia's '*Local Capacities for Peace*' Project, 2001 to 2004.

Professional Experience

Project Manager, World Vision Indonesia

2014 – 2018

From 2014 to 2018, I served as a Project Manager at World Vision Indonesia, where I directed a four-year, \$950,000 World Bank-funded social accountability initiative designed to improve maternal and child health services in rural areas. In this role, I led the project team to apply World Vision's Citizen Voice and Action to engage mothers of under-five children in 60 villages in rural Indonesia in assessing local maternal and child health service performance; and to facilitate

structured dialogues between communities, service providers, and local governments on how to improve the services. This work demonstrated how citizen voice can strengthen service delivery in under-resourced settings, producing lessons that inform similar challenges of health disparities and community engagement such as in rural America. Drawing on this experience, I co-author a forthcoming book chapter entitled “Extending Informal Civic Education and Engagement to Underrepresented Communities” that will be published by American Political Science Association (APSA).

In addition, I collaborated with Dr. Gillian Westhorp, a leading scholar in realist evaluation at Charles Darwin University, to design the project evaluation. As part of project evaluation, I led the project team to collect data annually, co-facilitated annual participatory data analysis workshops, and shared the findings and lessons learned with the internal and external stakeholders. Realist evaluation is a theory-driven evaluation that seeks to understand what works, by which mechanisms, for whom, and in what contexts. The theories are stated in C-M-O (Context-Mechanism-Outcome) configurations. In this evaluation, we collected and analyzed both quantitative and qualitative data to test the pre-defined theories, to understand the pathways of changes (outcomes), especially the mechanisms that work in specific contexts. The final evaluation report is available at:

<https://documents1.worldbank.org/curated/en/331651607355519716/pdf/Final-Evaluation-Report.pdf>

Peacebuilding Specialist, World Vision Indonesia

2010 – 2014

From 2010 to 2014, I worked as a Peacebuilding Specialist with World Vision Indonesia, leading conflict assessments and integrating conflict sensitivity into World Vision Indonesia’s development and humanitarian programs. I travelled extensively across Indonesia to provide technical supports for field project staff on how to conduct conflict assessments and integrate it into their programs. In addition, I worked collaboratively with field staff, grant acquisition manager, and national monitoring and evaluation team to develop, implement, and evaluate “Papua Peace Education” project in Papua and “Harmony Education” project in Central Sulawesi. These projects embedded local cultures into educational materials to help teachers and students in teaching and learning process to improve literacy and numerical skills while building civic attitudes and skills for peacebuilding and conflict transformation. This experience illustrates how culturally grounded programming can build community resilience in fragile contexts and strengthen social cohesion—an issue equally important in the United States.

Peacebuilding and capacity development specialist, World Vision Indonesia

2008

In 2008, I worked as a peacebuilding and capacity development specialist in World Vision Indonesia’s Aceh Development Program. Following devastated earthquake and tsunami in Aceh in 2004, World Vision and many international and national agencies worked to provide humanitarian

aid as well as for the reconstruction. Starting in 2007, World Vision continued with development program to assist local communities and governments to recover and rebuild their society. Using my previous experience, I worked in Aceh to enhance capacities of local staff in planning, implementing and evaluating community development projects. This includes how to apply conflict sensitivity in development programs. Aceh experienced decades of violent conflict between Aceh Freedom Movement and Government of Indonesia.

Program Manager, World Vision Indonesia

2004 – 2007

From 2004 to 2008, I was a Program Manager for World Vision Indonesia's Banggai Area Development Program, overseeing multi-sectoral initiatives in early childhood education, primary school teacher professional development, maternal and child health, nutrition, water and sanitation, and microeconomic development with an annual budget of \$300,000. Through participatory approaches in planning, implementation, and evaluation, I worked to empower rural residents in over 50 villages to improve social outcomes in the region. Working collaboratively, we assist community members in these villages to establish community self-help groups at village level to assess community needs, develop program planning, and implement programs to improve the children's well-being and strengthen community capacities in rural areas. These experiences provide a comparative perspective on community empowerment and local governance that is directly relevant to rural development challenges, including in the United States.

Local Capacities for Peace Project Coordinator, World Vision Indonesia

2001 – 2004

From 2001 and 2004, I served as a Project Coordinator of World Vision's Local Capacities for Peace Center of Learning in Indonesia. In this capacity, I led the project team to conduct annual conflict assessments—through focus group discussions and key informant interviews with various stakeholders—that seek to understand the dividers and connectors between community groups that are in tensions in Central Sulawesi province in Indonesia. This region was deeply affected by inter-religious violence.

Using Do No Harm or Local Capacities for Peace framework, we analyzed how community development programs may positively or negatively affect the dividers and connectors and generated options to improve the programs. I shared lessons on integrating peacebuilding and conflict sensitivity into development programming, contributing to a global evidence base for conflict-sensitive development practices. Together with other World Vision colleagues, I co-developed “Integrating Peacebuilding and Development” module to provide guideline for conflict-sensitive development across Word Vision programs globally. In addition, I co-facilitated numerous training and workshops on conflict-sensitive development programs in different countries in Asia and Africa. Furthermore, I co-authored a book chapter based on the lessons learned from this project, published by World Vision in a book entitled: “A Shared Future: Local Capacities for Peace in Community Development.” This book is available at <https://www.wvi.org/publication/shared-future>.

Food Aid Monitor, World Food Programme

1999 – 2000

I began my professional career with the World Food Programme in 1999–2000 as a Food Aid Monitor, where I monitored food distributions and assessed food security among East Timorese refugees in West Timor. Over 250,000 refugees fled from East Timor to West Timor following the widespread violence erupted after the referendum in 1999 that resulted in Timor Leste as a new country. Numerous UN agencies and international organizations provided humanitarian aid for the refugees, including the UN World Food Programme that coordinates food aid distributions. As part of my role, I met with WFP's implementing partners and assisted with weekly coordination meetings among humanitarian aid agencies working on food aid distribution and food security for the refugees. This early work grounded me in humanitarian operations and gave me first-hand experience in supporting vulnerable populations in crisis contexts, and it became an entry point that shaped my subsequent focus on rural development and participatory governance.

Conferences and Presentations

- “Signals and Voice: Performance grades and parental coproduction in NYC public schools”, *Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)*, Seattle, November 2025.
- “Do citizens reward high performers or prioritize failing services? The role of performance information in participatory budgeting”, *Association for Budgeting and Financial Management (ABFM)*, Atlanta, October 2025.
- “Who uses 311? Equity in ICT-Based Coproduction”, *International Management Science Conference 2.0*, June 2025.
- “Evaluating and Improving Civic Engagement in the Southern U.S.: Comparing Findings, Inequalities, and Action Plans Across Three States”, *Network of Schools of Public Policy, Affairs, and Administration (NASPAA)*, Washington D.C., October 2024.
- “Evaluating and Improving Civic Engagement in the Southern U.S.: Comparing Findings, Inequalities, and Action Plans Across Three States”, *Southern Conference for Public Administration (SECoPA)*, Memphis, September 2024.
- “Citizen Participation and Government Performance: A Cross-Country Analysis”, *Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)*, Chicago, April 2023.
- “Does Participatory Budgeting Alter Public Service? Evidence from New York City”, *Association for Budgeting and Finance Management (ABFM)*, Miami, Sept 2022.
- “Does Participatory Budgeting Alter Public Service? Evidence from New York City”, *Midwest Public Affairs Conference (MPAC)*, Springfield, IL, June 2022.
- “Citizen Participation and Government Performance”, *Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Student Research Online Seminar*, May 2021.

- “*Approaches to Evidence for Social Accountability. Realist Evaluation: What is it and what does it offer?*” with Gill Westhorp, World Bank’s Global Partnership for Social Accountability Webinar, April 2019.
- “*System Strengthening, Shifting of Local Power Dynamics and Women’s Empowerment: New Evidence on the Impact of Social Accountability in Indonesia*” with Gill Westhorp, World Bank’s Global Partnership for Social Accountability Webinar, March 2019.
- “*Citizen Voice and Action: Improving Basic Services through Social Accountability Approach*”, Indonesia Development Forum, Jakarta, 2018.
- “*Social Accountability through Citizen Voice and Action*”, Asia Pacific Leaders Forum, Jakarta, December 2017.
- “*Lessons Learned from Citizen Voice and Action for Government Accountability and Improved Services*”, 4th Open Government Partnership (OGP) Global Summit, Paris, December 2016.
- “*Building Capacity in Realist Evaluation in International Development*” with Gill Westhorp, 2nd International Conference on Realist Evaluation and Synthesis, London, October 2016.
- “*Citizen Voice and Action for Government Accountability and Improved Services*”, World Bank’s Global Partnership for Social Accountability, Washington, D.C., October 2017, and May 2016.

Additional Training and Certificates

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| - <i>Online Teaching Seminar Certificate</i> | 2022 |
| University of Missouri | |
| - <i>Realist Evaluation</i> | 2014 |
| Community Matters Pty Ltd | |
| - <i>JPAL 101x: Evaluating Social Programs</i> | 2014 |
| Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) through edX | |
| - <i>Certificate III in Humanitarian Services</i> | 2006 |
| The University of Melbourne | |

Honors and Awards

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| - Fulbright Doctoral Program | 2018 – 2023 |
| - USAID Human and Institutional Capacity Development Program | 2009 – 2010 |

Professional Memberships

- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)
- Association Society for Public Administration (ASPA)
- Association for Budgeting and Financial Management (ABFM)
- Public Management and Research Association (PMRA)
- The Global Honor Society for Public Affairs and Administration (Pi Alpha Alpha)